Hande Sevgi

Philadelphia, PA

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EMPLOYMENT

Swarthmore College 2026 – Present
Department of Linguistics *Swarthmore, PA*
Visiting Assistant Professor

EDUCATION

Harvard University 2026
Linguistics (PhD) *Cambridge, MA*
Dissertation: *Manner Modification Across Modalities: Insights from Gesture, Sign, and Spoken Language*
Committee: Kathryn Davidson, Jonathan David Bobaljik, and Kathryn Franich

Boğaziçi University 2019
Linguistics (MA) *İstanbul/Türkiye*
Effects of Age of Acquisition on Morphosyntactic Structures in Turkish Sign Language: Evidence from Classifiers
Advisor: Dr. Kadir Gökgöz

Boğaziçi University 2014
Translation and Interpreting Studies (BA) *İstanbul/Türkiye*
Senior Project Thesis: *Translating Political Economy Texts through a Functionalist Lens: A Skopos-Based Translation and Analysis of "The Migration and Labor Question Today" by Raúl Delgado Wise*
Advisor: İsmail Kaplan

RESEARCH EXPERTISE

Primary areas

- ◇ Sign language linguistics
- ◇ Experimental semantics and pragmatics
- ◇ Morphosyntax
- ◇ Co-speech gesture

Specialized interests

- ◇ Event structure and manner modification
- ◇ Classifier constructions in sign languages
- ◇ Age-of-acquisition effects in sign languages
- ◇ Information structure
- ◇ Turkish ideophones and expressivity
- ◇ Morphosyntax of Turkic languages
- ◇ Iconicity across signed, spoken, and gestural modalities
- ◇ Negation and its interaction with (non-)linguistic elements and meaning

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Papers Published

Sevgi, Hande, & Kadir Gökgöz. 2023. Classifiers, Argument Expression, and Age of Acquisition Effects in Turkish Sign Language. *Sign Language & Linguistics, 26*(1). doi.org./10.1075/sll.21006.sev

Journal Papers in Progress

Sevgi, Hande, & Kathryn Davidson. (Revising manuscript in response to reviewer feedback). Where are your manners: Experiments on information structure and manner adverbials in Turkish.

Sevgi, Hande. (Revising manuscript in response to reviewer feedback). Two-Handed Classifiers in Turkish Sign Language: An Analysis of the Non-Dominant Hand.

Book Chapters

Gökgöz, Kadir, & **Hande Sevgi**. 2020. Aspects of clause structure and morphology in Turkish Sign Language. In Gürer, Aslı, Dilek Uygun-Gökmen and Balkız Öztürk (Eds.). *Morphological Complexity within and across Boundaries*. John Benjamins Publishing Company. doi.org/slcs.215.12gok

Kayabaşı, Demet, **Hande Sevgi**, & A. Sumru Özsoy. 2020. Null arguments in Turkish Sign Language. In Gürer, Aslı, Dilek Uygun-Gökmen and Balkız Öztürk (Eds.). *Morphological Complexity within and across Boundaries*. John Benjamins Publishing Company. doi.org/10.1075/slcs.215.14kay

Gökgöz, Kadir, Demet Kayabaşı, & **Hande Sevgi**. 2020. Syntax, Chapter 2: Clause Structure, Section 2.1: The syntactic realization of argument structure. In Kelepir, Meltem (Ed.) *A Grammar of Turkish Sign Language (TİD)*. SIGN-HUB Sign Language Grammar Series.

Edited volumes

Daria A. Bikina & **Hande Sevgi**. 2023. Proceedings of the Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic: Vol. 8. Linguistic Society of America.
journals.linguisticsociety.org/proceedings/tu

Proceedings

Sevgi, Hande. 2024. One root to build them all: Roots in sign language classifiers. In Autry, Robert, Gabriela de la Cruz Sanchez, Luis A. Irizarry Figueroa, Kristina Mihajlovic, Tianyi Ni, Ryan Smith, and Heidi Harley (Eds.). *Proceedings of West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics, 39*(2), pp. 393-400.

Sevgi, Hande & Kadir Gökgöz. 2024. Age of acquisition effects in zero-anaphora comprehension in Turkish Sign Language. In AlThagafi, Hayat Abdullah Ali and Jupitara Ray (Eds.). *Proceedings of Boston University Conference on Language Development, 48*(2), pp. 481-493.

Kirby, Ian L. & **Hande Sevgi**. 2023. Plural Possession in Turkish and Sakha. In Lee, Si Kai, Sarah Asinari, and Sabine Lazakovits (Eds.). *Proceedings of the Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic, 7*(1), pp. 73-87. doi.org/10.3765/ptu.v7i1.5320 (Peer reviewed)

Sevgi, Hande. 2022. Verb doubling in Turkish: Evidence from Trabzon dialect. In Gündoğdu, Songül, Sahar Taghipour, and Andrew Peters (Eds.). *Proceedings of the Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic, 6*. doi.org/10.3765/ptu.v6i1.5063 (Peer reviewed)

Works in Progress

Sevgi, Hande, and Kathryn Davidson. Manner in Gesture and Language: An Experimental Approach.

PRESENTATIONS

Sevgi, Hande, & Kathryn Davidson. Not iconicity but manner: Turkish ideophones under negation. Talk to be presented at LSA, San Francisco, January 6-9, 2027.

Sevgi, Hande. 'Gesture Type Matters: Encoding Path and Manner in Space.' Poster presented at the International Max Planck Research School (IMPRS), Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics, the Netherlands, June 5-7, 2024.

Sevgi, Hande. 'Two-Handed Classifiers in Sign Languages: An Investigation in Turkish Sign Language.' Paper presented at the 60th Meeting of the Chicago Linguistic Society (CLS 60), University of Chicago, April 26-28, 2024.

Sevgi, Hande, & Kadir Gökgoz. 'Age of Acquisition Effects in Zero-Anaphora Comprehension in Turkish Sign Language.' Poster presented at the 48th Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD 48), Boston University, November 2-5, 2023.

Kirby, Ian & **Hande Sevgi**. 'Plural possession in Turkish and Sakha.' Paper presented at the 7th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic (Tu+7), University of Connecticut, February 18-19, 2022.

Sevgi, Hande. 'Syntax on its own is not enough: Sign language classifiers.' Poster presented at the 57th Meeting of Chicago Linguistic Society (CLS 57), University of Chicago, May 6-8, 2021.

Sevgi, Hande. 'One root to build them all: Roots in sign language classifiers.' Poster presented at the 39th Meeting of West Coast Conference, University of Arizona, April 8-11, 2021.

Sevgi, Hande. 'Verb doubling in Turkish: Data from Trabzon dialect.' Paper presented at the 6th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic (Tu+6), University of Toronto, February 19-20, 2021.

Sevgi, Hande & Kadir Gökgöz. 'To what extent does age of acquisition matter: Evidence from Turkish Sign Language (TİD).' Poster presented at Formal and Experimental Advances in Sign language Theory (FEAST), Universitè de Paris, June 23-25, 2020.

Sevgi, Hande. 'The Role of Syntax in Interpretation of the Particle "bile".' Paper presented at the 3rd Budapest Linguistics Conference (BLINC3), ELTE, Hungary, June 6-8, 2019.

Sevgi, Hande & Kadir Gökgöz. '(Non)Effects of Age of Acquisition in Turkish Sign Language Morpho-Syntax: Evidence from Classifiers and Argument Expression.' Paper presented at the 55th Meeting of Chicago Linguistic Society (CLS 55), University of Chicago, May 16-18, 2019.

Özsoy, Sumru, Samet Demirtaş, Gül Yiğit, **Hande Sevgi**, Demet Kayabaşı, Kadir Gökgöz. Sağır Çocukların İşaret Dili Edinmesinin Önemi (The Importance of Sign Language Acquisition for Deaf Children). Paper presented at 10th National Congress of Language and Speech Disorders, İstanbul Medipol University, Turkey, April 28-May 1, 2019.

Sevgi, Hande, Belgin Dinç, Didar Akar, Balkız Öztürk, Ceyda Arslan Kechriotis, Nicolas Kontovas, and Aslı Göksel. İstanbul'un Miras Dillerinin Türkçe ile Etkileşimi (Interaction of Turkish with Heritage Languages of Istanbul). Paper presented at 33rd National Conference on Turkish Linguistics (UDK), Mersin University, Türkiye, May 9-10, 2019.

Gökgöz, Kadir, Samet Demirtaş, Gül Yiğit, **Hande Sevgi**, Demet Kayabaşı, Sumru Özsoy. Sağır çocuklarda işaret ve konuşulan dil edinim konuları ve süreçleri (Acquisition Issues and Processes Sign and Spoken Language by Deaf Children. Roundtable presentation at 33rd National Conference on Turkish Linguistics (UDK), Mersin University, Türkiye, May 9-10, 2019.

Sevgi, Hande. 'bile' parçacığının sözdizimsel analizi (A Syntactic Analysis of 'bile'). Poster presented at 31st National Conference on Turkish Linguistics, Anadolu University, Türkiye, May 12-13, 2017.

Sevgi, Hande. A Syntactic Analysis of 'bile' (even). Paper presented at 11th Student Conference on Linguistics, Mersin University, Türkiye, April 20-21, 2017.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor at Swarthmore College

Introduction to Language & Linguistics	Fall 2026
Sociolinguistics: Language, Culture, and Society	Fall 2026

Tutorial head instructor at Harvard University

Sophomore Tutorial: Sign Languages & Linguistics	Spring 2024
Sophomore Tutorial: A Brief Introduction to Sign Language Linguistics	Spring 2023
Junior Tutorial: Understanding Language through Sign Languages	Fall 2022

Teaching fellow at Harvard University

Practicum (Instructor: Jonathan David Bobaljik)	Spring 2024

Language, Structure, and Cognition (Instructor: Adam R. Singerman) Spring 2022
The Science of Language: An Introduction (Instructor: Yağmur Sağ) Fall 2021
Word Structure (Instructor: Jonathan David Bobaljik) Fall 2021

Research assistant at Boğaziçi University
Morphology (Instructor: Mine Nakipoğlu, 73 students) Spring 2019
Phonetics (Instructor: Kadir Gökgöz, 58 students) Spring 2019
Syntax (Instructor: Sumru Özsoy, 58 students) Fall 2018
Phonology (Instructor: Stefano Canalis, 51 students) Fall 2018
Phonetics (Instructor: Kadir Gökgöz, 53 students) Spring 2018
Syntax and Semantics of Modern Turkish (Instructor: Balkız Öztürk, 53 students) Spring 2018
Phonology (Instructor: Kadir Gökgöz, 42 students) Fall 2017

Turkish Language and Culture Program, Boğaziçi University
Instructor of Speaking Course, Pre-Intermediate Turkish Class Summer 2019
Teaching Assistant, Advanced Turkish Class Summer 2018

TEACHING AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

Dissertation Completion Fellowship Fall 2024–Spring 2025
Harvard University

Mind, Brain, and Behavior Graduate Student Award Spring 2024–Fall 2024
Harvard University ($5000)

Bok Teaching Certificate Spring 2023
Derek Bok Center for Teaching and Learning, Harvard University
Upon completing a multi-semester elective program in pedagogy, teaching, and course design.

Student Recognition of Teaching
Harvard Kenneth C. Griffin Graduate School of Arts and Sciences
Awarded by the Office of Academic Programs for achieving student evaluation scores of 4.5/5 or higher.
- Awarded for Ling 98A, Tutorial Head Instructor Fall 2022

Certificate of Distinction in Teaching
Harvard University
Awarded by the Derek Bok Center for Teaching and Learning and the Office of Undergraduate Education for achieving student evaluation scores of 4.5/5 or higher.
- Awarded for Ling 83, Discussion Section Spring 2022
- Awarded for Ling 104, Discussion Section Fall 2021

Certificate on German 2014
Boğaziçi University, Istanbul
Awarded by the School of Foreign Languages upon completing 21 credits of coursework.

Erasmus Grant Sept 2011–Feb 2012
European Union
Awarded through the Erasmus Student Exchange Programme to study
Applied Language Studies at Lessius University College, Antwerp, Belgium.

INVITED TALKS AND GUEST LECTURES

Sign Languages and Linguistics
Guest lecture at Harvard University
LING-S 101 instructed by Daria Bikina August 4, 2026
LING-S 101 instructed by Ankana Saha July 24, 2025
LING 101 instructed by Tanya Bondarenko November 6, 2024
LING 101 instructed by Yağmur Sağ November 28, 2022
LING 101 instructed by Yağmur Sağ November 29, 2021

Sign Language Morphology
Guest lecture at Harvard University
LING 104 instructed by Jonathan David Bobaljik — November 12, 2024
LING 104 instructed by Jonathan David Bobaljik — November 16, 2021

A Visit to the Sign Language World — October 18, 2022
Invited talk
Harvard Undergraduate Linguistics Society (HULS)

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Supporting Sign Language Development of Deaf Children with Hearing Parents through Linguistically-Informed Preschool Stories — 2018–2019
Position: Research Assistant
(funded by Boğaziçi University, #11500)
PI: Dr. Kadir Gökgöz, Boğaziçi University

Language Contact in Turkey: Documentation and Analysis — 2016–2019
Position: Research Assistant
(funded by Boğaziçi University, #1445)
PI: Dr. Aslı Göksel, Boğaziçi University

Contrastive interlanguage analysis of French, Portuguese, Japanese, and Turkish — 2016–2017
Position: Responsible for data collection
PI: Dr. Yuji Kawaguchi, TUFS

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Pedagogy Fellow of Linguistics Department — 2023–2024
Harvard University

Lab Manager of Meaning and Modality Lab — 2023–2024
Harvard University

Assistant Head Tutor of Linguistics Department — 2022–2023
Harvard University

Co-organizer of the Eighth Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic (Tu+8) — March 4-5, 2023
with Daria A. Bikina
Harvard University, the Department of Linguistics
WEBSITE

Co-coordinator of East Coast Five (ECO-5) on behalf of Harvard University — 2022–2023
with Aljoša Milenkovič

Co-coordinator of Harvard Linguistic Universals Colloquium Series — 2021–2023
with Yuhan Zhang (2021) & Daria Bikina (2022)

Representative of graduate students of Linguistic Department — 2016–2017
Boğaziçi University

Conference Reviewer — 2023–Present
The Annual Meeting of the Chicago Linguistic Society (CLS)
The Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic (Tu+)

Journal Reviewer — 2026–Present
Folia Linguistica

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Generative Model Evaluator Aug 2026–Present
Mercor (Project Vault)
Evaluate and compare large language model outputs for instruction following, reasoning quality, factual consistency, and natural language style; provide structured feedback to improve model response quality.

Generative Model Evaluator - Intern Jun 2025–Nov 2025
Mercor (Project Elephant)
Designed and reviewed human-in-the-loop evaluation tasks for large language models, with a focus on linguistic reasoning, semantic interpretation, and model behavior in domain-specific tasks. Developed evaluation criteria and error taxonomies combining qualitative linguistic analysis with quantitative metrics; identified model failure modes to support model diagnostics and robustness evaluation.

OTHER RELATED AFFILIATIONS

Member of Meaning and Modality Lab 2019–2026
Harvard University

Sign Language Linguistics Society (SLLS) 2023–Present

Linguistics Society of America 2025–Present

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Turkish	Native
English	Fluent
German	Upper Intermediate (good RD, fair SP)
Turkish Sign Language (TİD)	Research proficiency
American Sign Language (ASL)	Research proficiency

Languages of Interest: Turkish, Turkish Sign Language (TİD), American Sign Language (ASL), Romeika (Pontic Greek), Bahasa Bali, Icibemba.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: R, Python, SQL
Technologies: ELAN, Qualtrics, RStudio, LaTeX, TeXEditor, PCIbex, PRAAT, Adobe Animate

REFERENCES

Kathryn Davidson	Jonathan David Bobaljik	Kadir Gökgöz
Harvard University	Harvard University	Boğaziçi University
Professor of Linguistics	Professor of Linguistics	Associate Professor of Linguistics
kathryndavidson@fas.harvard.edu	bobaljik@fas.harvard.edu	kadir.gokgoz@bogazici.edu.tr